



Beyerdynamic TYGR 300 R

The new open back gaming headphones sport a lightweight design and supports studio amplifiers, mixers, etc. <http://dgit.in/feb21-77>



V-Moda M-200 ANC

V-Moda has launched its first ANC Bluetooth headphones, bringing 40mm drivers designed for high-res output. <http://dgit.in/feb21-78>

Skullcandy Hesh ANC

Democratising Active Noise Cancellation

Skullcandy has grown to become one of the most recognisable audio brands across the globe, that is primarily associated with providing bass-forward headphones and earphones. In this review, we are checking out the Skullcandy Hesh ANC, a budget pair of Active Noise Cancellation-enabled over-ear wireless headphones. Let's see how the Skullcandy Hesh ANC fares.

Build and comfort

The Skullcandy Hesh ANC headphones are made out of plastic and have a mix between matte and glossy texture. The ear cups are soft to the touch and are extremely comfortable to wear since the pads are made out of memory foam. The headband, on the other hand, is a bit too thin for our liking. The headphone features a portable, collapsible design where the earcups can be folded inwards. The earcups can also swivel 180 degrees.

The right earcup houses all the buttons and ports. On the bottom, there's a USB Type-C port for charging and a 3.5mm audio jack for wired usage, which is pretty handy if the battery dies out. Just above you have all the controls. The buttons are well-placed, easy to use and have a sufficient amount of tactility.

ANC and other features

The Skullcandy Hesh ANC is equipped with Active Noise Cancellation, which is rare for headphones at the 10K price point. Not only that, but the headphones also come with Ambient Sound, that allows background sound inside. Now, the ANC cannot really compete with the heavyweights in the Bluetooth headphones segment, however, the performance is perfectly acceptable for this price range. The headphone manages to muffle low, constant sounds pretty convincingly, however, it doesn't do well with human voices, high-speed fans, mechanical



keyboards, and other mid-high range sounds. The Ambient Sound Mode is pretty decent as well, although it does sound a tad unnatural at times.

The headphones are powered by Bluetooth v5.0. It misses out on some features such as an IP rating, multi-connect, and auto pause/play. At this price range though, we can forgive Skullcandy for skipping these features. However, one feature we sorely missed that we wish Skullcandy had incorporated was app support.

Performance

Moving onto the sound quality, the Skullcandy Hesh ANC comes with a bass-forward sound profile that adds an extra oomph to genres such as hip hop, EDM, rap, and Bollywood. No surprises there. Although, keep in mind that if you activate ANC when listening to music, the punchiness of the bass will be taken down a few notches.

Even with ANC off, however, the bass response is not overwhelmingly boosted and the mids and vocals aren't shrouded completely by it. There's slight auditory masking in the mids in bass-heavy tracks such as *bad guy* by *Billie Eilish* but it isn't extremely jarring. Vocals are pretty clear, for the most track, apart from tracks such as *Selkies*

by *Between the Buried and Me*, which features a ton of instruments that veil the vocals slightly. The headphones support SBC and AAC codecs, which is acceptable at this price range. The highs are decent enough as well, although, they can be slightly tinny at times. Coming to instrument separation and imaging, the Hesh ANC does a decent job at both. The soundstage is decently wide as well, although it doesn't feature much height at all.

Battery life

Sporting a battery life of 22 hours with Active Noise Cancellation turned on, according to Skullcandy, these headphones have a pretty impressive battery life, especially in this price segment. In our testing, we recorded 20.5 hours of total battery life with ANC turned on and the volume set to about 80

per cent. We needed to set the volume higher than usual since the headphones aren't loud enough around the 60-70 percent mark.

Verdict

The Skullcandy Hesh ANC is a pretty decent purchase at ₹10,999. If you're someone looking for a pair of headphones that come equipped with ANC, have a good battery life, and decent sound quality without breaking the bank, these are good headphones to consider. Bass lovers, especially, will enjoy the punch and thump in the bass response. The build quality and fit of these headphones are also pretty good, making the Hesh ANC an overall good budgetary purchase.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

HEADPHONE TYPE: Bluetooth Over-Ear | CONNECTION TYPE: Bluetooth 5.0 | IMPEDANCE: 32 Ohms ±15% | DRIVER DIAMETER: 40mm | THD: <3% | SOUND PRESSURE LEVEL: 99.63 | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20Hz - 20KHz | WEIGHT: 228g | BATTERY LIFE: 22 hours with ANC on

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